international and regional order but also started playing a significant role in emerging international relations.

That is why scholar Zhang Maorong (2011) defended establishing the BRICS countries in international relations. Maorong says that when the BRICS were trying to upgrade their economic profile, the US-led Western powers registered negative consequences in the global framework due to their financial crisis affecting these emerging economies nations. International institutions also failed to stand by the emerging nations when needed help. This was why a new group such as the BRICS was crucially needed to be formed to sustain itself, i.e., Global South countries. Thus, the formation of BRICS at Yekaterinburg in 2009 received worldwide attention. Nikolai Kodorov (2017) stated that:

> The BRICS is a forum of regional powers, pretending for a more significant role in world politics to bring change in global governance, “alternative” to G7.

The demand for a more democratic international order and a just and equitable representation in global institutions intensified within such a context. It led to the emergence of BRICS as a robust forum. In this process, southern countries have been forming regional and inter-regional groups to ensure their interests collectively. The quintessential groups include BRICS, BASIC, RIC (Russia, India, China), and IBSA. Among all these groups, BRICS is the most prominent because of its transcontinental nature and the scope of the multilateral work that it can carry out. Thus, BRICS displays a critical paradigm shift in world politics. Cox (2012) says that the clout of the Western world in international relations is now being sapped of its power rapidly. The southern world has been rising since the early twenty-first century, which the BRICS group is replacing. BRICS collectively defends the reform of global institutions in promoting their economic and political interests (De Ouro-Preto 2013). Therefore, the Western world regularly negates the rise of the BRICS group in international politics. However, apart from that, the West was forming policies to destabilize the BRICS global role. One such policy was former US President Obama's strategy for rebalancing Asia.